The journal: every trade after the fact

The third program on the desk. Trades come in from broker files or straight from Alpaca accounts. They are paired into round trips and measured: P&L, win rate, drawdown, and results by hour, weekday, price, size and setup.

It stands on its own. It shares the desk’s login, the app bar and the program registry. Its one link out is the 📈 button, which opens qp’s chart of the trade. In a rebuild it becomes part of the web front (REBUILD-ARCHITECTURE.md).

Process	`journal` under pm2, `node journal/server.js`, port **3100**
Page	one page, eight tabs, all numbers computed in the browser
Its data	`data/journal/journal.db` (SQLite) and `journal-accounts.json` (Alpaca keys, mode 0600)
Ways in	file import (five detected formats), Alpaca accounts on a schedule, a hand-entry route
Calls out	Alpaca (fills; bars), Yahoo (bars)
Code	`journal/`: about 8,000 lines, 22 files

Where it stands

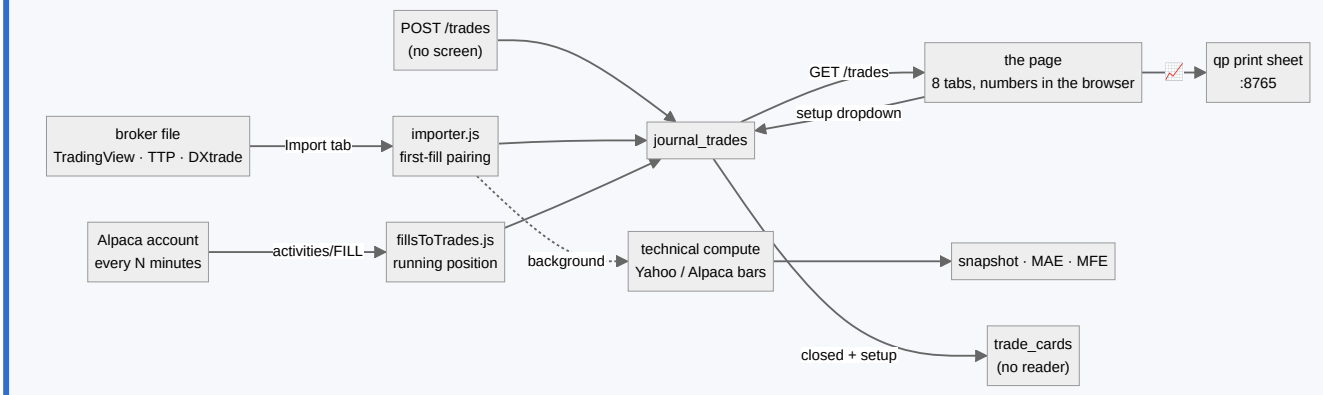
Read this before the details. The review behind these documents ran every import format on a scratch database and measured what the analysis can produce.

Part	State
Alpaca accounts	**good.** The pairing is right (weighted prices, reversals split, stable ids) and tested. Two gaps: positions older than the look-back window (D-J11) and overnight trades (D-J12)
The page and its numbers	**good.** Clear formulas, filters that apply to every tab, a correct calendar. But R is empty everywhere, because no trade has a stop (D-J9)
File imports	**broken.** Scale-ins and scale-outs are mispaired, TradingView shorts are lost, the paper log fails, TTP orders and hand-closed DXtrade trades import nothing, and a second import duplicates everything (D-J1 to D-J7). No test covers it
Technical snapshot	**unreliable.** Wrong bar for morning trades half the year (D-J8); RVOL, ATR, pre-market and context are never filled; multi-day levels see after the entry (D-J13); computed for imports only, and shown nowhere
Conditions and grading	**inert.** Two condition systems; 55 of the 77 checks can never answer; a fresh database has no setups; no reader of the grading data (D-J13, D-J14)
Chart button	marks the trade 4 to 5 hours early (D-J10)

Read in this order

#	Document	Answers
1	PAGE.md	every tab, control and number on the page, with formulas
2	ACCOUNTS.md	the Alpaca accounts: settings, keys, schedule, how fills become trades
3	IMPORT.md	the file formats, how fills are paired, hand entry, editing; what was tested
4	ANALYSIS.md	the technical snapshot, the two condition systems, the grading bridge, the check library, the grading engine
5	DATA-MODEL.md	every file and table, who writes and reads it, the leftovers
6	API.md	every route, and whether anything calls it
7	OPERATIONS.md	the process, start-up, the timer, environment, the tests
8	KNOWN-ISSUES.md	open findings (D-J1 to D-J20), and what was fixed

How a trade moves through it



The code, file by file (`journal/`)

File	Lines	Does
`server.js`	161	the app: schema repair, login, routes, setup list, accounts, app bar
`src/db/index.js`	146	opens `journal.db`; also creates the old app's screener tables and settings
`src/journal/db.js`	135	the journal's own seven tables
`src/journal/importer.js`	383	file import: format detection, four parsers, pairing (IMPORT.md)
`src/routes/journal.js`	407	19 routes under `/api/journal` (API.md)
`src/addons/accounts.js`	327	Alpaca accounts: the key store, the schedule, five routes (ACCOUNTS.md)
`src/addons/fillsToTrades.js`	174	fills into round trips by running position
`src/journal/technicalFetch.js`	338	bars, the entry snapshot, MAE, MFE, R (ANALYSIS.md)
`src/journal/alignment.js`	142	the 18 template rules
`src/journal/bridgeToGrading.js`	241	copies closed, tagged trades into `trade_cards` and judges library checks
`src/journal/analysis.js`	98	the server's metrics and calendar
`src/trading/checks.js`	1,934	the check library: schema, 77 seeds, the condition evaluator
`src/trading/grading.js`	738	the grading tables; its functions have no caller
`src/trading/db.js`	194	the setup table, plus the removed live engine's tables and settings
`src/trading/dailyLevels.js`	195	multi-day levels (5-day MA, anchored VWAPs, highs and lows)
`src/trading/historicalCache.js`	150	a history cache for those levels; never filled in the journal
`src/trading/volumeBaseline.js`	170	the RVOL baseline; never built in the journal
`src/alpaca/client.js`	240	market-data bars and the key search; its account calls are unused
`src/yahoo/client.js`	143	used only by the history cache

File	Lines	Does
`src/utils/time.js`	24	New York date and time helpers
`public/journal.html`	1,080	the page
`public/addons.js`	558	the app bar, accounts panel, setup filter, chart button, two-tap delete

More than a third of the code (`checks.js`, `grading.js`, the trading tables, the cache and baseline) came from the removed live trading engine and does nothing the page shows.

Rules a rebuild must keep

Getting trades in

1. **Pair fills by running position**, for every source: volume-weighted entry and exit, a reversal split into two trades, open positions kept as open trades. The Alpaca path already does this (ACCOUNTS.md).
2. **A stable id from the source's own facts, including the account.** Fetching or importing again updates; it never duplicates.
3. **A trade the person has worked on is never overwritten** by a later fetch.
4. **Report what was not used**: unmatched fills, open positions, skipped rows.
5. **A sample file and tests for every format**, with shorts, scale-ins, scale-outs and partial closes.

Keys 6. **Broker keys stay on the box**: mode 0600, outside git and backups, never sent back to a page, used only for read calls.

Time 7. **Store real instants for entry and exit**, each with its own date. Show them in New York time. A trade's day is New York's.

Numbers 8. **One definition per number**, written down, computed in one place. Closed trades only, and a 0 trade defined once. 9. **Every trade has a stop**, so every trade has an R. 10. **Filters narrow one list that every view draws from.**

Analysis 11. **A snapshot is as of the entry minute**: no bar after the entry, history fetched for multi-day levels, the right time zone, and no "last bar" fallback. 12. **Only build what a screen shows.** Every route and table has a reader.

Operations 13. **A failed fetch is recorded with its reason** and waits for its turn.

What not to copy

- the file importer’s first-fill pairing, random ids and silent drops (D-J1 to D-J7);
- one `date` plus two clock times per trade (D-J12);
- New York clock times written as UTC and passed on as instants (D-J10);
- a fixed −05:00 offset for New York (D-J8);
- a snapshot that reads tables nothing writes, or bars after the entry (D-J13);
- two condition systems, and a grading engine with no input and no reader (D-J14, D-J16);
- the old app’s tables and settings in the journal’s database (D-J16);
- a fee setting that is stored but never applied (D-J15).